

film review

Time-pass

NAQAAB

Director: Abbas Mustan
Starring: Bobby Deol,
Akshaye Khanna,
Urvashi Sharma

Abbas Mustan's latest thriller isn't as much fun as their earlier hits *Aaitraaz* or *Humraaz*, but it isn't as dreary as *36 China Town*, which was a mystery so lame that the butler had actually done it.

Naqaab is about a poor but always groomed-and-gorgeous girl in Dubai who is torn between two handsome men. But an ominous presence records her every move on a handy-cam,



Khanna (left) and Deol with Sharma in the film

suggesting that this princess may not live happily ever after. The first half of the film twists and turns nicely with enough suspense, but by the second half, the game has become monotonous. Still, the actors are engaging:

Deol and Khanna both have their moments and newcomer Urvashi Sharma makes an attractive foil for the men. She has talent and confidence. The film's crisp two-hour length makes it strictly "time-pass". **by Anupama Chopra**

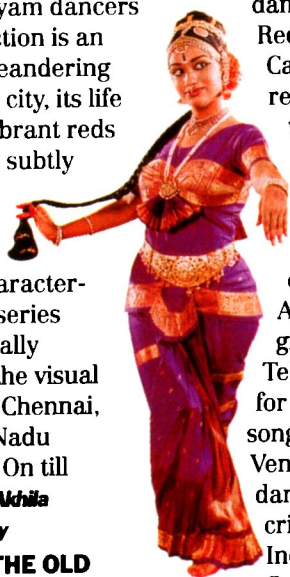
recommendations

Traditional Fare

CHENNAI It's time to soak in some art as two popular galleries in the city play host to a palette of artistic sensibilities. At Vinnyasa Premium Art Gallery, artists Anand Panchal, Datta Bansode, Gautam Mukherji, Nitin and Pravin Utge, Prakash Deshmukh and Sanjay Kumar will showcase their works in a collective exhibition titled 'The Lure of Tradition'. At the Apparao Galleries, Kolkata-based artist Ranadip Mukherjee's Chennai series is on display. Drawing inspiration from

the city and its traditional motifs—temples, musicians and Bharatanatyam dancers—this collection is an aesthetic meandering through the city, its life and soul. Vibrant reds and yellows subtly toned down by shades of blue are characteristic of this series that artistically celebrates the visual tradition of Chennai, and Tamil Nadu as a whole. On till July 30. **by Akhila Krishnamurthy**

CHIP OFF THE OLD BLOCK: Yamini Reddy



SUMEET INDER SINGH

DELHI After her marriage, Yamini Reddy, daughter and disciple of Kuchipudi dancers Raja and Radha Reddy, returns to the Capital for a unique recital. Apart from traditional repertoire, she will perform a special item, *Alrulu Kuriyaga*, based on the poetry of Annamacharya, the great Sanskrit and Telugu poet known for his devotional songs in praise of Lord Venkateshwara. Her dance is pure joy, say critics. On July 26, at India International Centre.

music reviews

Sacred Space



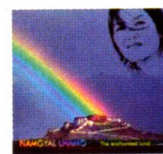
Silk Road
CD Rs 275

PURE

Music directors
Shankar-
Ehsaan-Loy

say she is arguably the best

Tibetan traditional singer of our times: "Her voice is absolute, pure and independent". One agrees with the assessment. The Netherlands-based singer Namgyal Lhamo's voice is not only versatile, but has an amazing range true to opera style. The eight numbers in the CD echo with the spirit of Tibet and prayers to be reborn in Tusheti, Buddha's abode. Her interpretations of the Nangma and the Toeshe, Tibetan classi-



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cal songs from the 17th century, are universally acclaimed.

THE ENCHANTED LAND

No wonder she is called the nightingale of Tibet. In her other album, a blend of Tibetan sounds and western instruments, Lhamo's experimentation with her hypnotic voice is pathbreaking. Co-produced with music producer Arnav Srivastava, the haunting songs effortlessly straddle Tibetan heights as well as lounge bars. A blend of pure, ambient spirit and electronic sounds, the album opens the frontiers of Tibetan music on to another level.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

SABU XAVIER JITHAN KALLAT
A.RAMACHANDRAN AKKITHAM
NARAYANAN RIAZ KOMU GEORGE.K
KRISHNAMACHARI BOSE K.C.S.PANIKER
P.G.DINESH S.G.VASUDEVALEXIS KERSEY
RAMESH RAO T.VAIKUNTAM
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